

Thinking Recursively

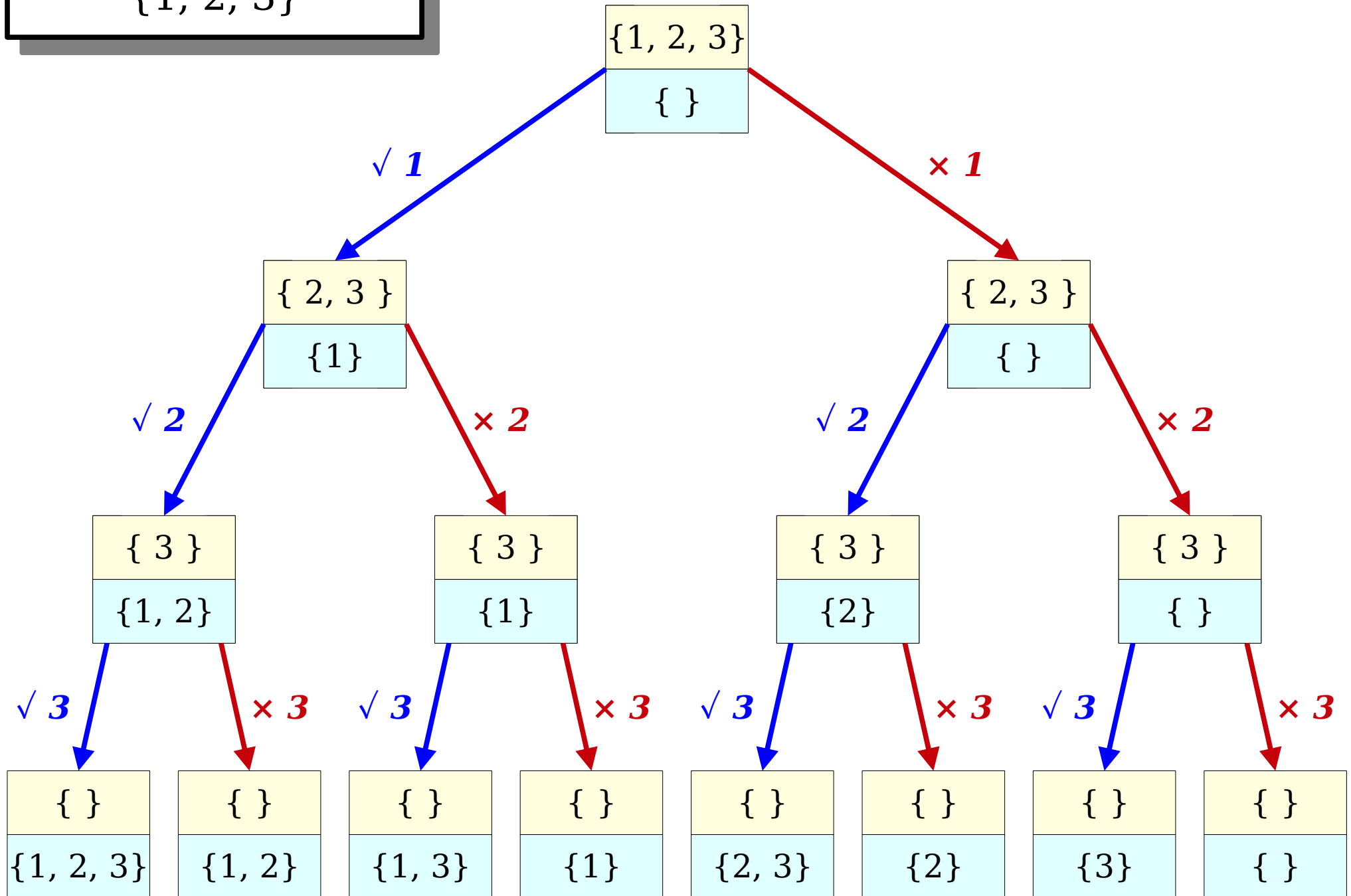
Part III

Outline for Today

- ***Iteration + Recursion***
 - Combining two techniques together.
- ***Enumerating Permutations***
 - What order should we do things?
- ***Enumeration, Generally***
 - How to think about enumeration problems.

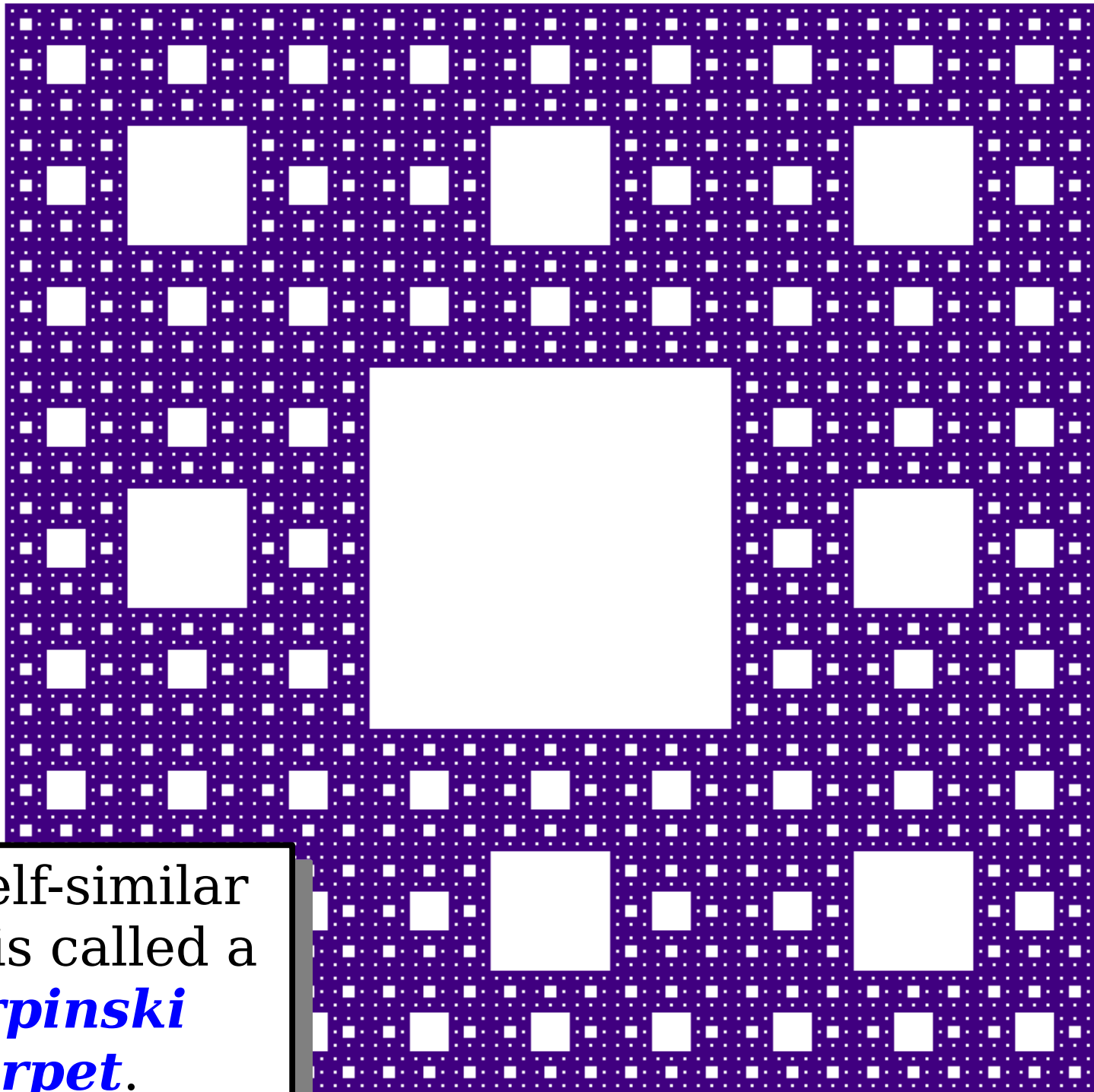
Recap from Last Time

List all *subsets* of
 $\{1, 2, 3\}$

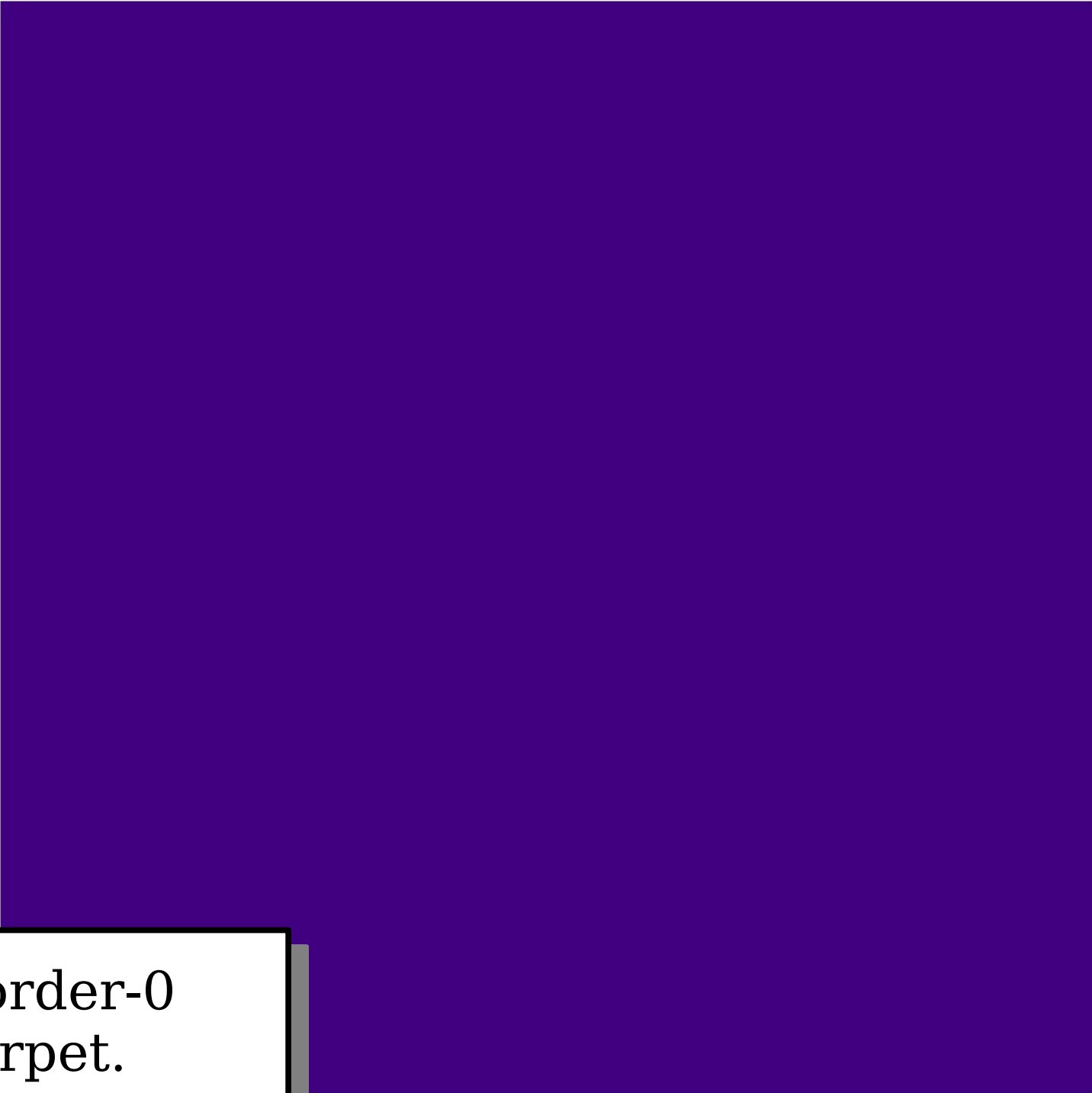


New Stuff!

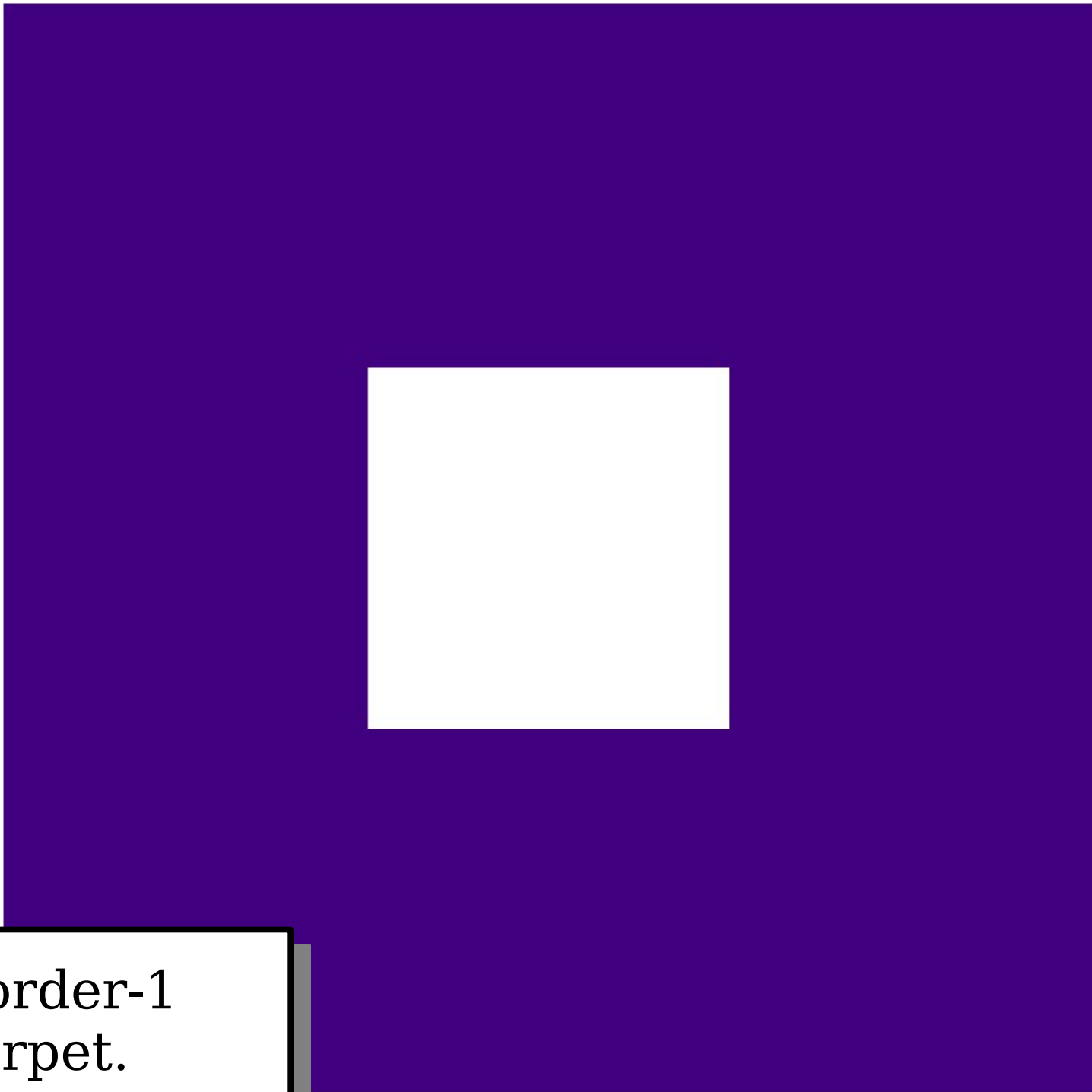
More On Self-Similarity



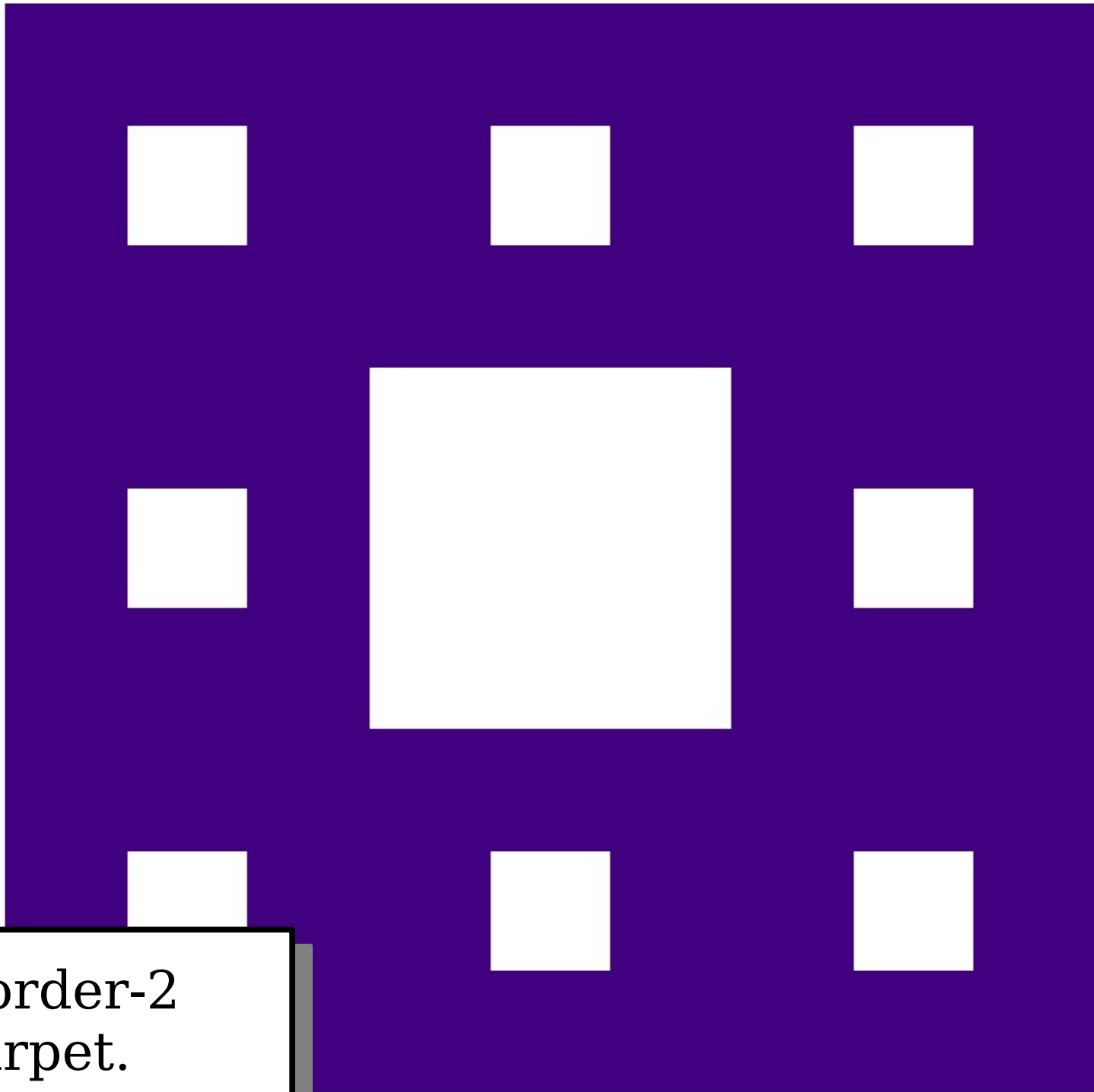
This self-similar
shape is called a
***Sierpinski
carpet.***



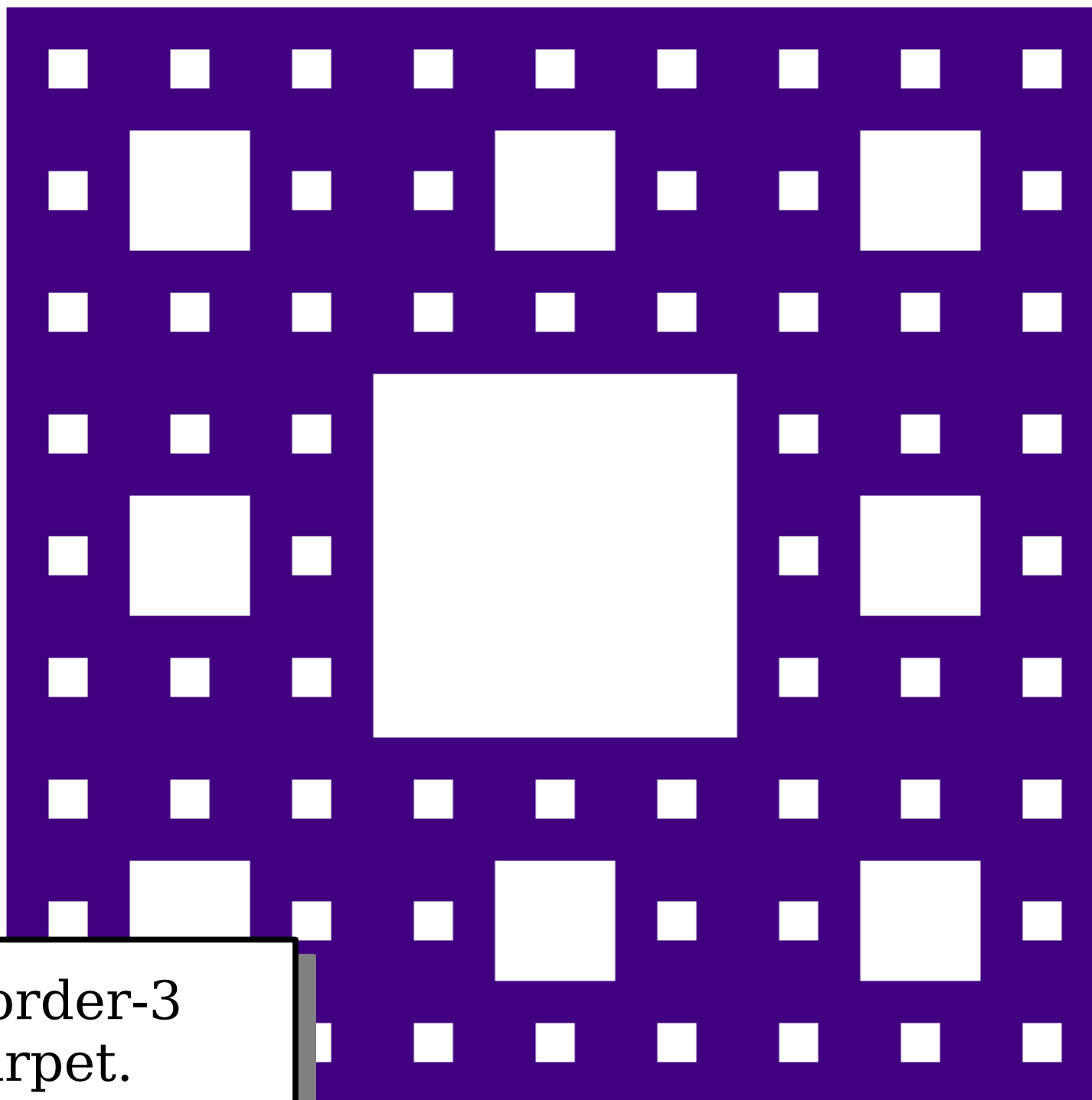
An order-0
carpet.



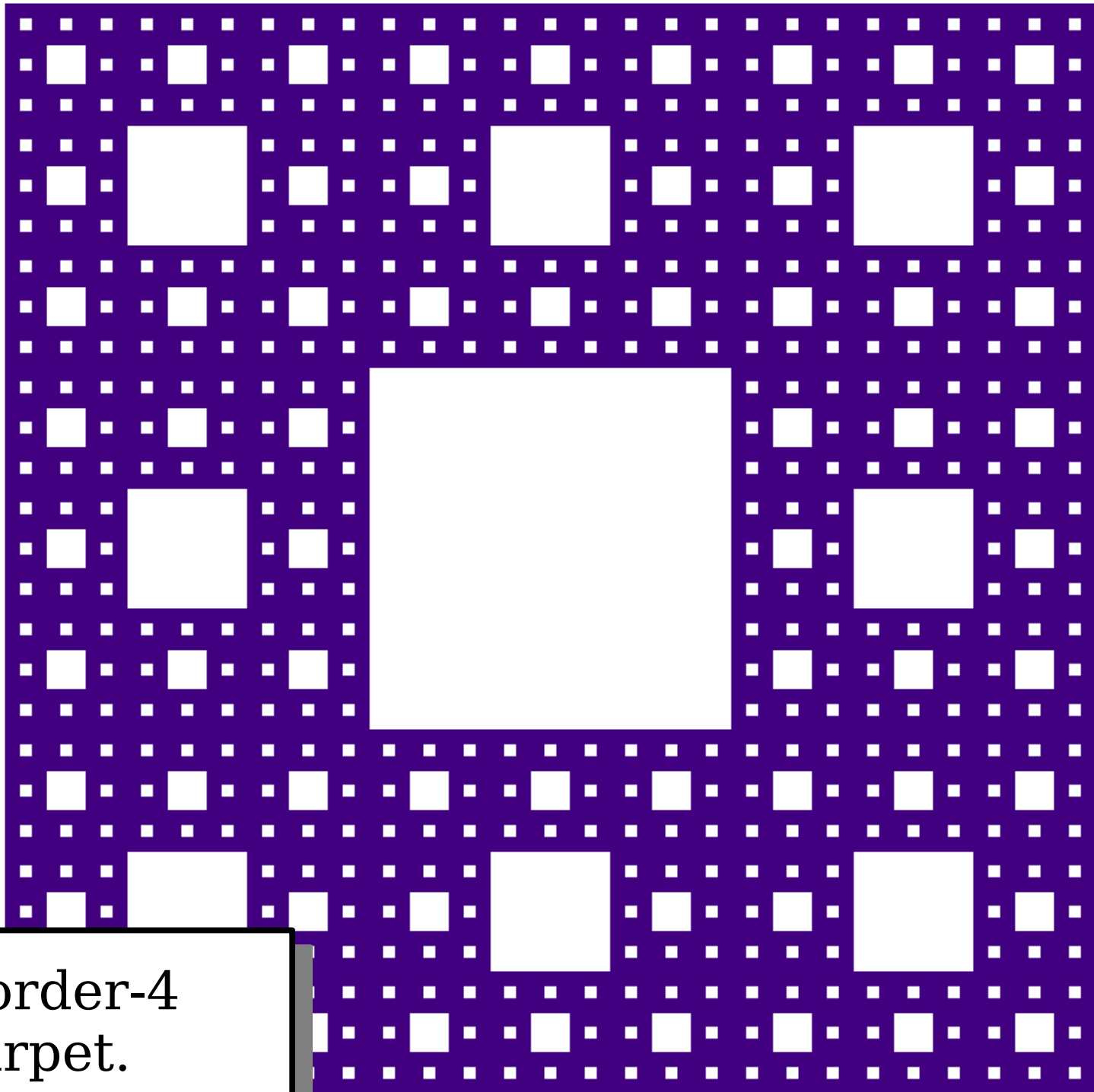
An order-1
carpet.



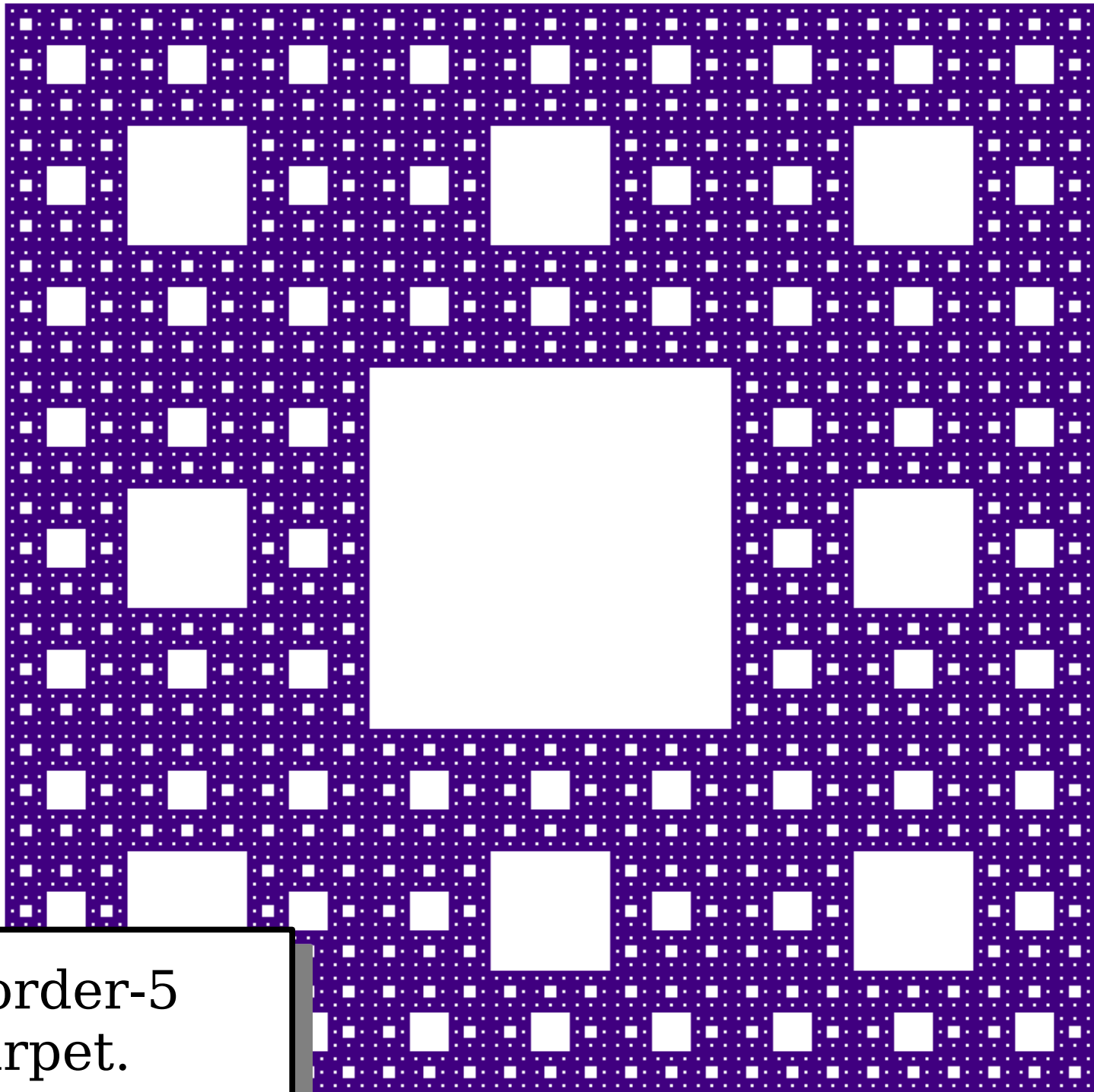
An order-2
carpet.



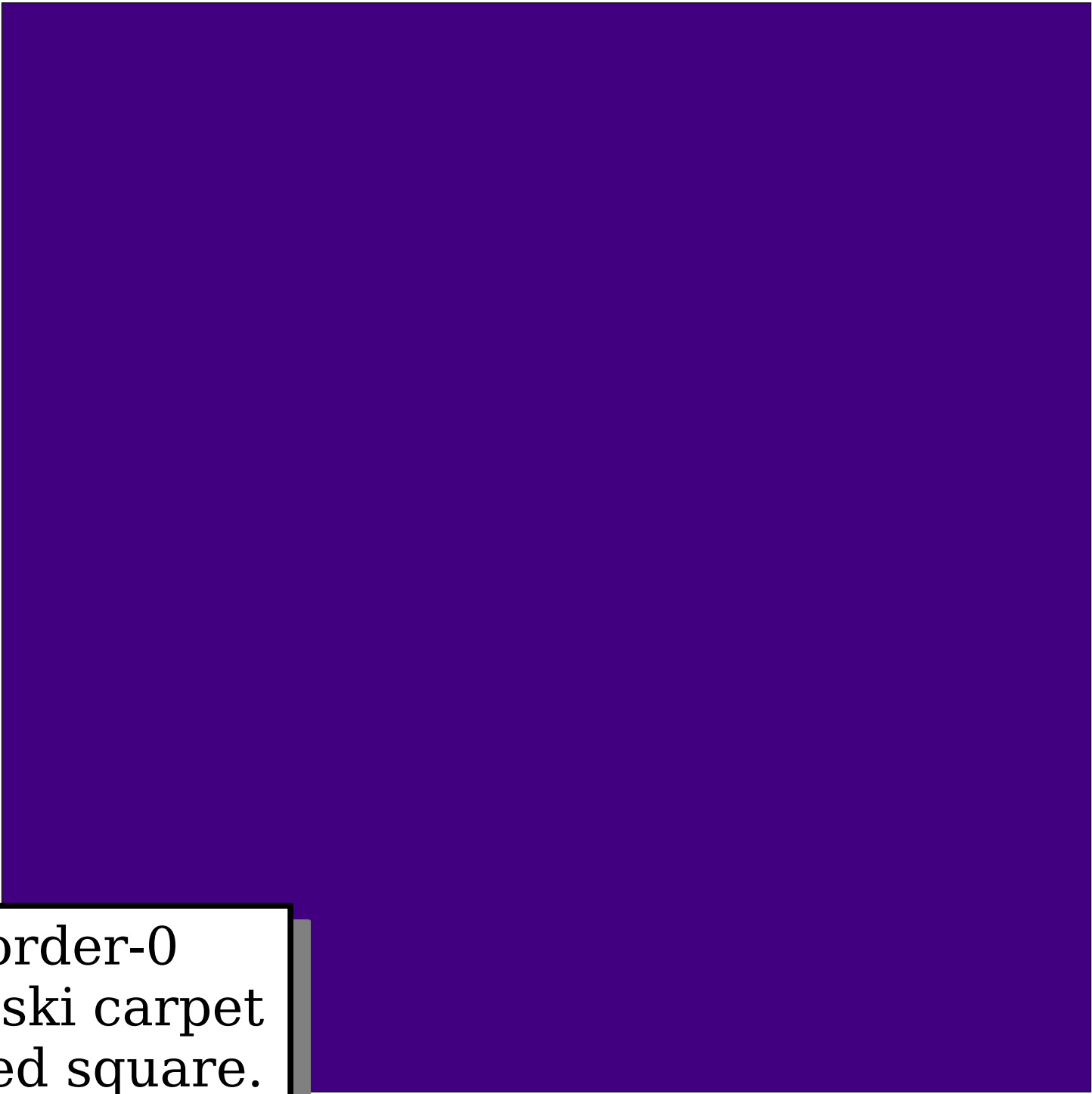
An order-3
carpet.



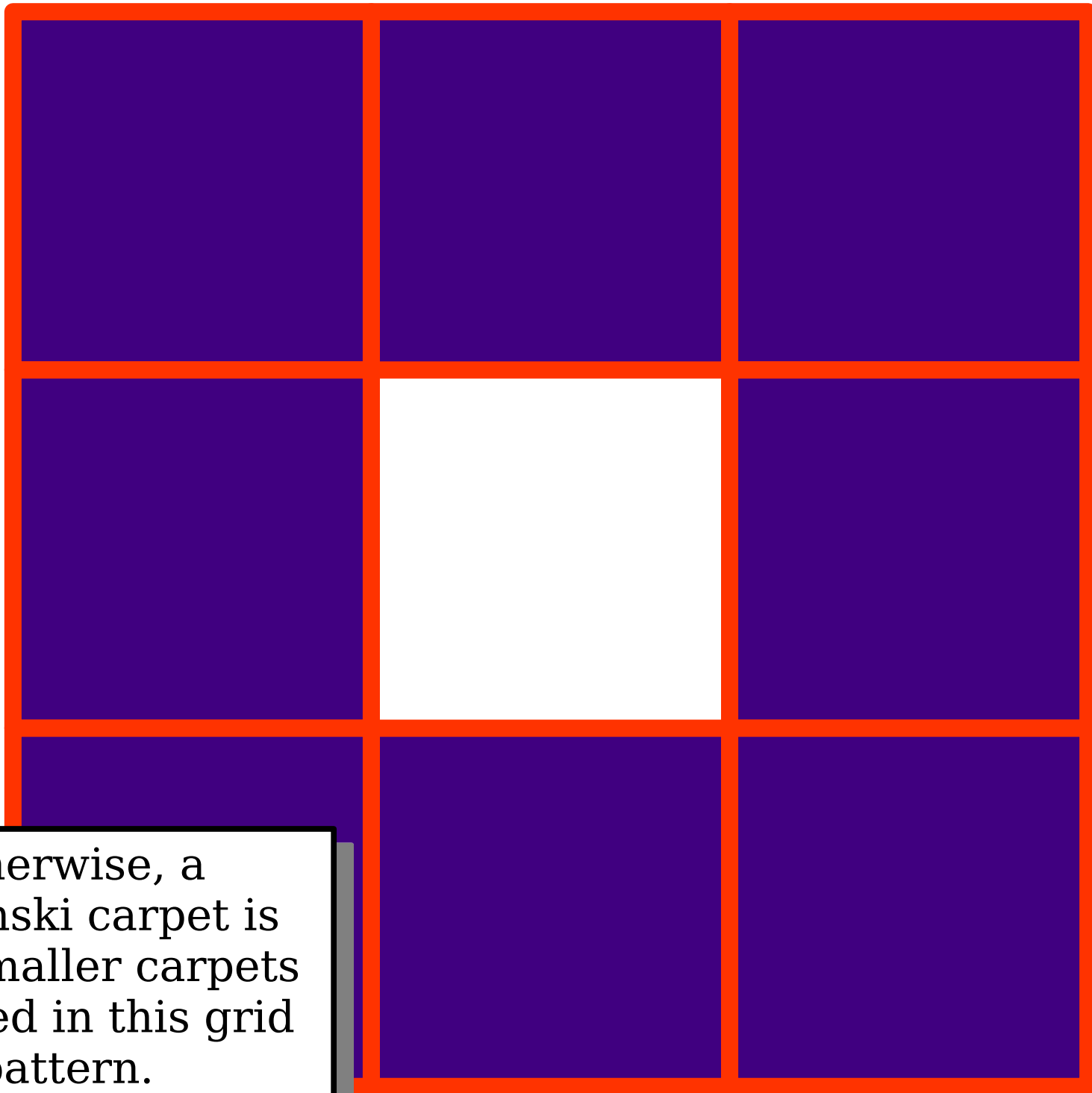
An order-4
carpet.



An order-5
carpet.



An order-0
Sierpinski carpet
is a filled square.



Otherwise, a
Sierpinski carpet is
eight smaller carpets
arranged in this grid
pattern.

$(0, 0)$	$(0, 1)$	$(0, 2)$
$(1, 0)$		$(1, 2)$
$(2, 0)$	$(2, 1)$	$(2, 2)$

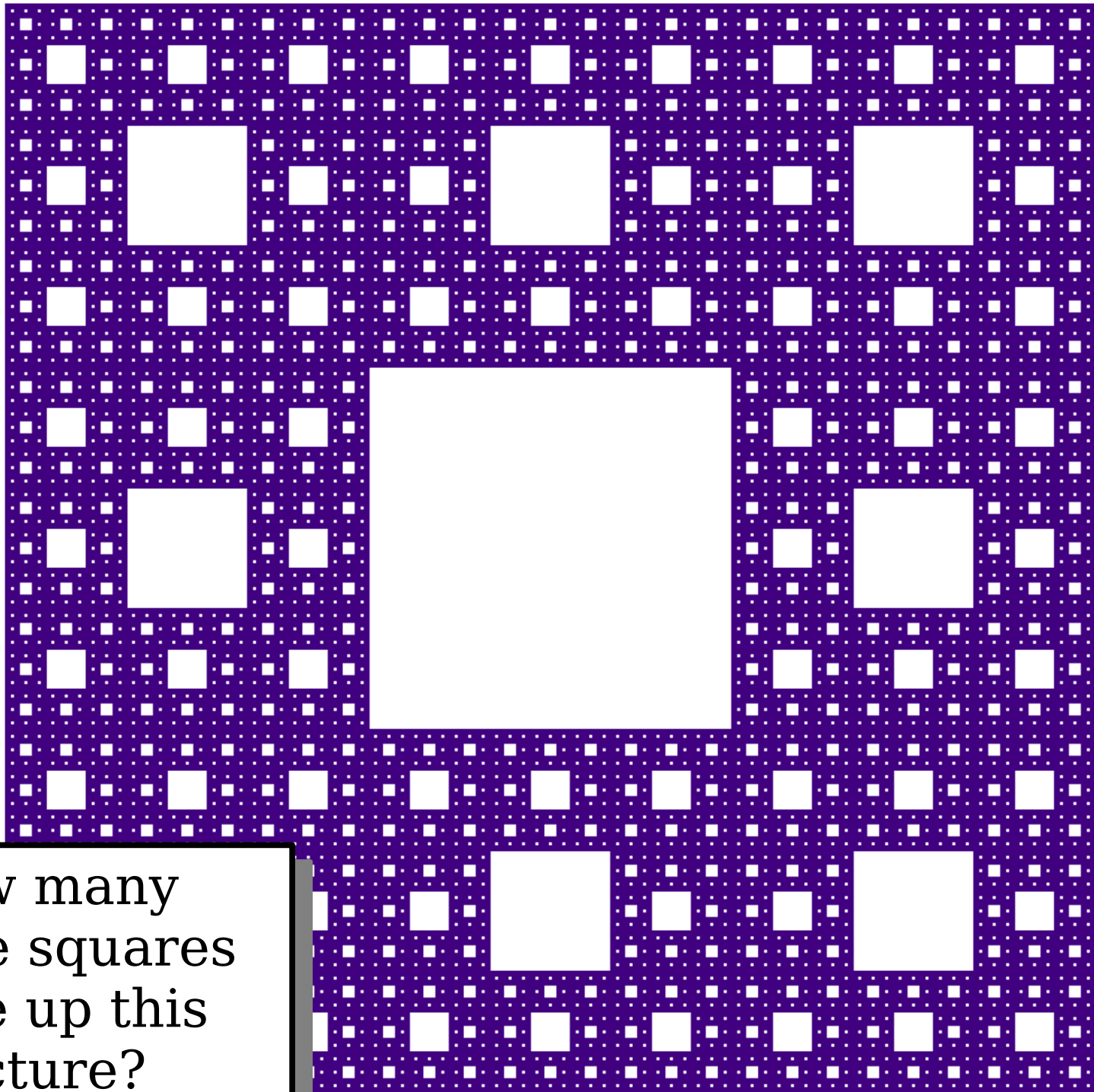
Label each square
with its (row, col).

$(0, 0)$	$(0, 1)$	$(0, 2)$
$(1, 0)$		$(1, 2)$
$(2, 0)$	$(2, 1)$	$(2, 2)$

We can visit each spot with a double for loop.

Iteration + Recursion

- It's completely reasonable to mix iteration and recursion in the same function.
- Here, we're firing off eight recursive calls, and the easiest way to do that is with a double for loop.
- Recursion doesn't mean "the absence of iteration." It just means "solving a problem by solving smaller copies of that same problem."



How many
purple squares
make up this
picture?

Time-Out for Announcements!

Assignment 3

- Assignment 2 was due today at 1PM.
 - You can use late days to extend the deadline by 24 or 48 hours. Remember that you only get four late days to use over the quarter.
- Assignment 3 (***A Visit to Recursia***) goes out today. It's due next Friday at 1:00PM.
 - Play around with recursion and recursive problem-solving!
 - Use recursion to generate mountain ranges!
 - Generate all words in a fictional language!
 - Make a neat building with recursion!
- YEAH hours are today, 4:30PM – 5:30PM, in Hewlett 101. Purely optional, but highly recommended.

Recursive Drawing Contest

- Our (optional, just for fun) Recursive Drawing contest ends on Monday at 1PM.
- If you're interested in participating, visit <http://recursivedrawing.com/>, draw something, and post it to EdStem.
- We're very impressed with the submissions you've made so far! If you haven't yet done so, go check them out.

(The Curtain Rises on Act II)

Enumerating Permutations

A ***permutation*** is a rearrangement of the elements of a sequence.



Lassen Volcanic National Park



Yosemite National Park



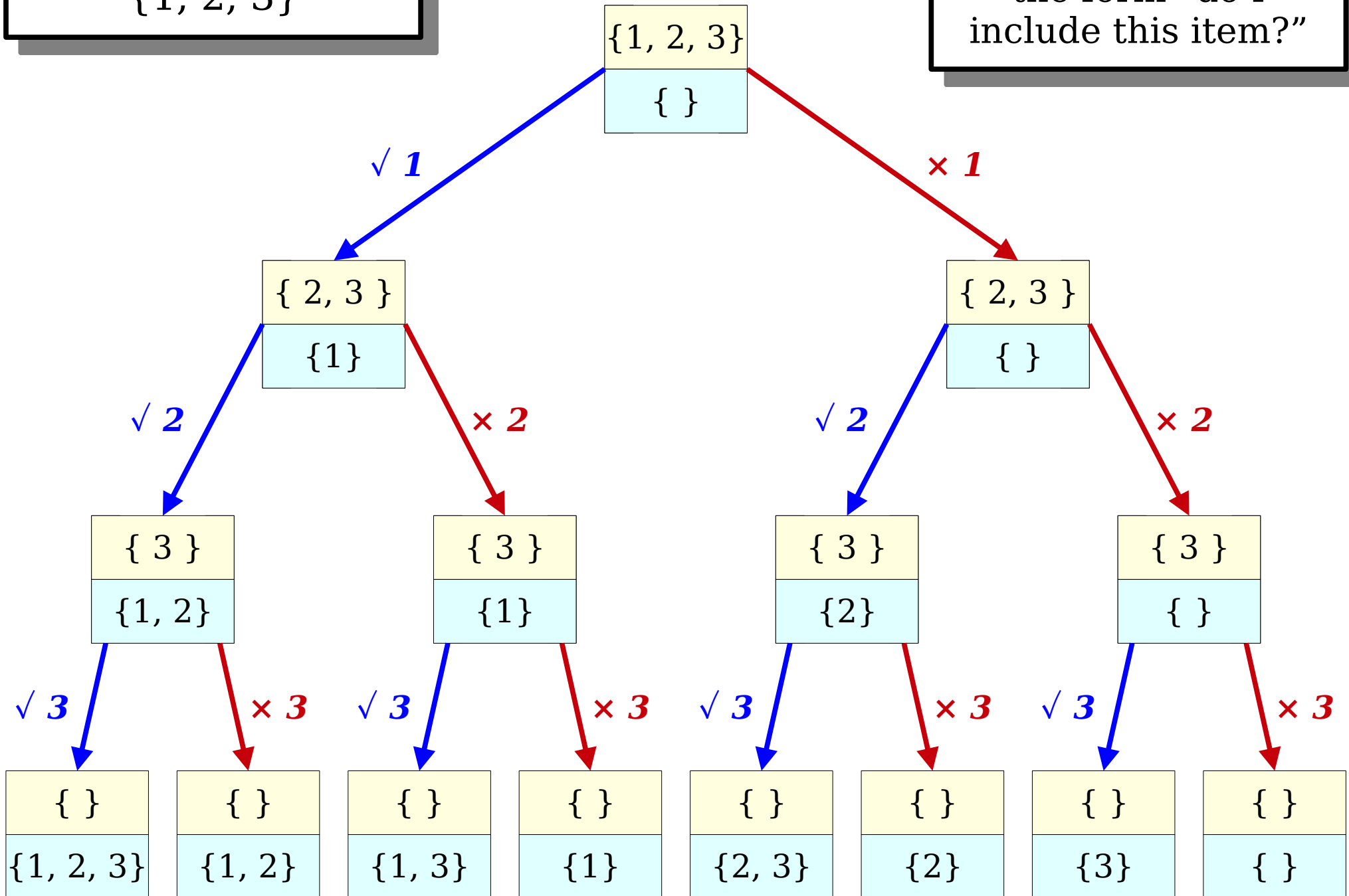
Joshua Tree National Park



Lava Beds National Monument

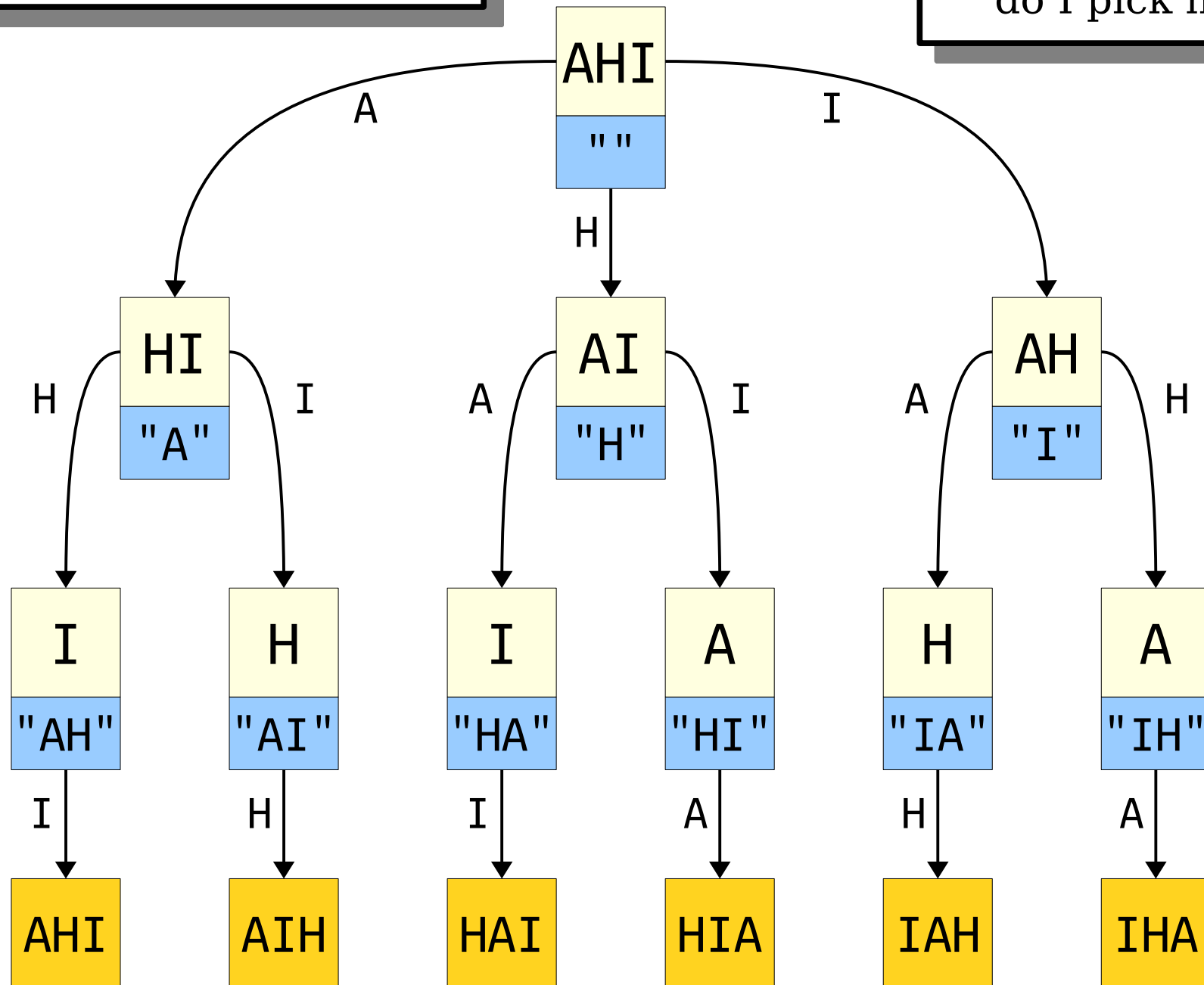
List all *subsets* of
 $\{1, 2, 3\}$

Each decision is of
the form “do I
include this item?”



List all *permutations* of
 $\{A, H, I\}$

Each decision is of
the form “which item
do I pick next?”

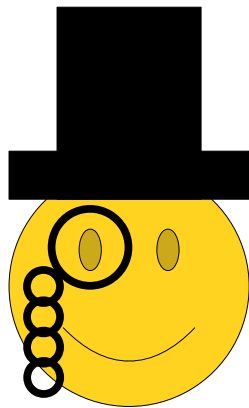


A Question of Parameters

```
listPermutationsOf("AHI", "");
```

```
listPermutationsOf("AHI", "");
```

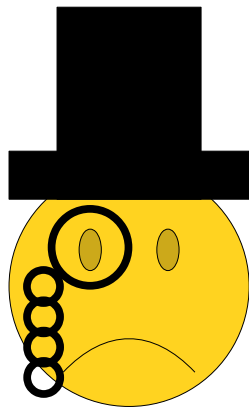
```
listPermutationsOf("AHI", "");
```



*I certainly must tell you
which string I'd like
to form permutations of!*


```
listPermutationsOf("AHI", "");
```

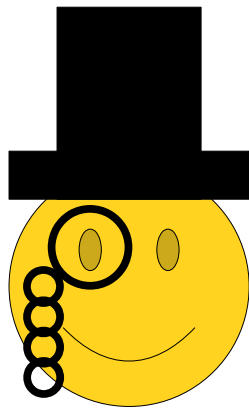
```
listPermutationsOf("AHI", "");
```



*Pass in an empty string every
time I call this function?
Most Unorthodox!*

```
listPermutationsOf("AHI");
```

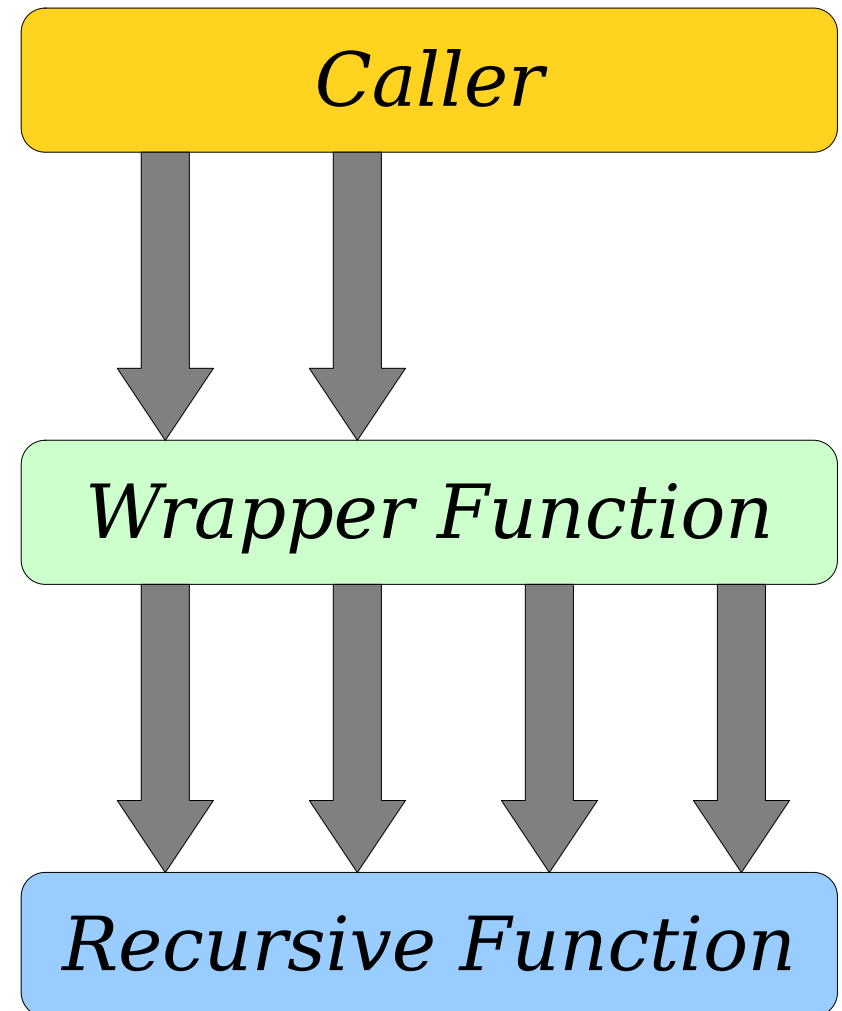
```
listPermutationsOf("AHI");
```



*This is more acceptable
in polite company!*

Wrapper Functions

- Some recursive functions need extra arguments as part of an implementation detail.
 - In our case, the string of letters ordered so far is not something we want to expose.
- A ***wrapper function*** is a function that does some initial prep work, then fires off a recursive call with the right arguments.

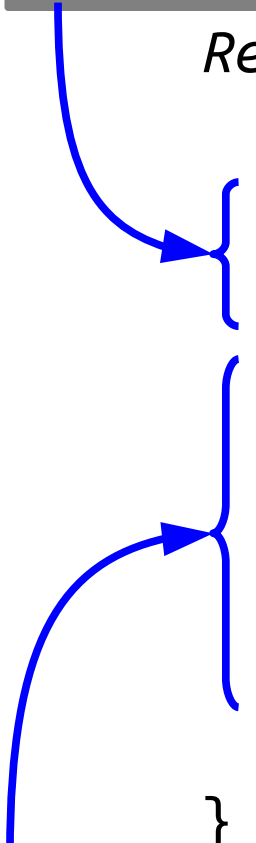


Storing Permutations

```
Set<string> permutationsOf(const string& str);
```

Base Case: No decisions remain.

```
ResultType exploreRec(decisions remaining,  
                     decisions already made) {  
    if (no decisions remain) {  
        return decisions made;  
    } else {  
        ResultType result;  
        for (each possible next choice) {  
            result += exploreRec(all remaining decisions,  
                               decisions made + that choice);  
        }  
        return result;  
    }  
}
```



Recursive Case:

Try all options for the next decision.

```
ResultType exploreAllTheThings(initial state) {  
    return exploreRec(initial state, no decisions made);  
}
```


Summary for Today

- Recursion and iteration aren't mutually exclusive and are frequently combined.
- We can enumerate subsets using a decision tree of “do I pick this?” We can enumerate permutations using a decision tree of “what do I pick next?”
- Recursive functions can both print all objects of some type and return all objects of some type.

Your Action Items

- ***Read Chapter 8***
 - There are so many goodies there, and it's a great way to complement what we're discussing here.
- ***Work on Assignment 3***
 - Aim to complete the Flag of Recursia and Mountains of Recursia by Monday, and aim to start working on Speaking Recursian.

Next Time

- ***Enumerating Combinations***
 - Can you build the Dream Team?
- ***Recursive Backtracking***
 - Finding a needle in a haystack.
- ***The Great Shrinkable Word Problem***
 - A fun language exercise with a cute backstory.